

CASE STUDY | PRESENTED BY FPT AUSTRALASIA

The B2A Shift: Adapting Retail for AI Shopping Agents

Designing merchant-side systems for a world where the customer is a machine.

How might product companies and retailers adapt to successfully market and sell to **autonomous AI shopping agents** rather than human consumers?

01 At a Glance

Challenge Owner	FPT Australasia (subsidiary of FPT Software)
Industry	Technology / IT Services
Organisation Size	Large (500+)
Website	fptsoftware.com/fpt-australasia
Domain	Agentic commerce, e-commerce infrastructure, semantic search
Solution Perspective	Merchant-side — how the business adapts to the buyer's agent

02 About the Organisation

FPT Australasia is the regional branch of FPT Corporation, a globally leading technology and IT services provider. The company partners with businesses across a range of industries to accelerate digital transformation through AI, cloud computing, data analytics, and modern software engineering.

Its mission is to help enterprises adapt to disruptive technologies and redefine their business models so they remain competitive in a rapidly evolving digital landscape — which is precisely the lens this challenge is framed through.

03 Background & Context

The Situation Today

E-commerce and digital marketing have, historically, been built entirely around human psychology. Retailers convert shoppers using visually appealing websites, emotional marketing, frictionless UI/UX, and traditional SEO.

A major paradigm shift is now underway. Consumers are increasingly delegating purchasing decisions to AI agents — advanced LLMs, autonomous smart home assistants, and AI shopping copilots. These agents crawl the web, compare specifications, read reviews, and execute purchases based on logical constraints and preferences set by their human owner.

Why This Is a Problem

AI agents do not care about flashy graphics, brand prestige, or emotional ad copy. They rely on structured data, API accessibility, deterministic facts, and machine-readable pricing.

Today, most product companies are effectively **invisible** to AI agents, or expose data that is easily misinterpreted — leading to hallucinated product claims and mismatched recommendations. A retailer whose platform cannot “speak” to an AI agent, or whose checkout flow an agent cannot navigate, risks losing significant market share in the emerging **Business-to-Agent (B2A)** economy.

What Has Been Tried

Approach	Limitation
Basic SEO and schema markup (rich snippets)	Built for search engines like Google — not for autonomous conversational agents executing complex, multi-step logic.
Experimental API endpoints at some brands	Isolated efforts. No comprehensive strategy or infrastructure for agentic commerce has been widely established.

04 The Challenge

Design and build a **merchant-side solution** that helps product companies and retailers decode, match, and fulfil the complex intentions of autonomous AI shopping agents — in other words, adapt to the B2A era.

Illustrative Directions

These are examples, not requirements. Teams are free to define their own approach.

Semantic Intention-Matching Engine

A catalogue layer that goes beyond basic specs (size, colour, price) and maps product features to *human outcomes*. When an agent queries for “beginner-friendly podcasting gear,” the system dynamically evaluates the catalogue and pitches the ideal bundle based on that intent.

Values-Based “SEO” for Agents

A dashboard that helps brands surface and structure their unstructured data — sustainability practices, ethical sourcing, long-term durability — so that when a buyer instructs their agent to “only buy from ethical brands,” the company’s products are successfully matched and validated.

Dynamic B2A Negotiation Protocol

An API-driven system that lets the retailer’s AI negotiate with the buyer’s AI. If the buyer’s agent is optimising against a strict budget, the merchant’s system might automatically offer a personalised discount or propose a slightly older model that fits the constraint exactly.

Target Users

User	Type	Technical Literacy
E-commerce Managers	Primary	Moderate to high
Chief Marketing Officers (CMOs)	Primary	Moderate
IT integration teams	Primary	High
Autonomous AI shopping agents	Secondary (machine consumer)	—

Scope & Boundaries

IN SCOPE

- B2A marketing strategies
- Semantic search mapping and intent-decoding logic
- Dynamic product bundling
- Machine-readable data structuring
- AI-to-AI negotiation protocols
- API-based checkout flows

OUT OF SCOPE

- Building a consumer-facing AI shopping assistant — the focus must stay on how the *business* adapts to the consumer’s agent
- Traditional human UI/UX optimisation
- Physical supply chain logistics

05 What a Good Solution Looks Like

Desired Outcome

An ideal solution lets a retail brand upgrade its digital storefront so that it doesn't merely *list products* — it actively *solves the human buyer's problem* via their AI agent.

A winning demonstration would show a merchant system:

1. **Receiving** a highly complex, multi-constraint query from a buyer’s agent, representing deep human intention, lifestyle context, and personal values.
2. **Decoding** that intent accurately.
3. **Analysing** its product catalogue dynamically against the decoded intent.
4. **Returning** a tailored, compelling proposal — not just a list of SKUs, but a logical justification of *why* these products match the buyer's specific intention.
5. **Closing** the loop through a seamless, API-driven transaction.

Evaluation Priorities

Judged at the Gala Pitching Night against the following, in order of weight.

- 1 **Intention Accuracy & Semantic Matching.** How intelligently the merchant's system decodes the nuanced needs of the human behind the agent, going beyond basic keyword or spec matching.
- 2 **Technical Architecture.** Viability and scalability of the solution — effective use of APIs, dynamic bundling, and LLM-to-LLM communication.
- 3 **Business Value & Conversion.** How well the solution helps a traditional product company win the sale by proving to the AI agent that its product is the best possible fit for the buyer.

Note on presentation: visual polish of human-facing dashboards is a **lower** priority than the logic of the machine-to-machine interaction.

06 Additional Notes for Teams

Welcome to the agentic economy.

Recommended Research Areas

- Agentic customers
- Agentic workflows
- LLMO (Large Language Model Optimisation)

A useful framing question: what friction does a *machine* encounter when trying to navigate a website built for humans? Consider CAPTCHAs, unreadable pop-ups, modal interruptions, and unstructured text.

FPT Australasia is excited to see how the brightest minds of 2026 tackle the future of commerce — and is open to discussing **internship opportunities and further incubation** for teams that build truly disruptive B2A solutions.

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